

General Knowledge — Q&A; Compendium

310 questions across Science, Politics, History, Geography, Space, Magic & Mythology, AI, and Tech.

Science

1. What is the chemical symbol for gold?

Ans: Au

2. What is the powerhouse of the cell?

Ans: Mitochondria

3. What gas do plants absorb from the atmosphere for photosynthesis?

Ans: Carbon dioxide

4. What is the SI unit of electric current?

Ans: Ampere

5. Who proposed the theory of general relativity?

Ans: Albert Einstein

6. What is the hardest natural substance on Earth?

Ans: Diamond

7. What is the boiling point of water at sea level in Celsius?

Ans: 100°C

8. What particle has a negative charge?

Ans: Electron

9. What is the study of fungi called?

Ans: Mycology

10. What is the most abundant gas in Earth's atmosphere?

Ans: Nitrogen

11. What organ produces insulin?

Ans: Pancreas

12. What is the chemical formula for table salt?

Ans: NaCl

13. What force keeps planets in orbit around the Sun?

Ans: Gravity

14. What is the smallest unit of life?

Ans: Cell

15. What is the pH of pure water?

Ans: 7 (neutral)

16. Which blood type is the universal donor?

Ans: O negative

17. What is the speed of light in a vacuum (approx)?

Ans: 299,792 km/s

18. What is the process by which plants make food called?

Ans: Photosynthesis

19. What is the atomic number of hydrogen?

Ans: 1

20. Who discovered penicillin?

Ans: Alexander Fleming

21. What is the largest organ in the human body?

Ans: Skin

22. What is the unit of frequency?

Ans: Hertz

23. What causes rust on iron?

Ans: Oxidation (reaction with oxygen and moisture)

24. What is DNA short for?

Ans: Deoxyribonucleic acid

25. What gas do humans exhale most of?

Ans: Carbon dioxide

26. What is the study of earthquakes called?

Ans: Seismology

27. Which element has the chemical symbol 'Fe'?

Ans: Iron

28. What type of energy is stored in a stretched rubber band?

Ans: Elastic potential energy

29. What is the freezing point of water in Fahrenheit?

Ans: 32°F

30. Who developed the periodic table?

Ans: Dmitri Mendeleev

31. What is the main function of red blood cells?

Ans: Carry oxygen

32. What is the largest bone in the human body?

Ans: Femur

33. What is the process of a solid turning directly into gas called?

Ans: Sublimation

34. What is the chemical symbol for potassium?

Ans: K

35. Which vitamin is produced when skin is exposed to sunlight?

Ans: Vitamin D

36. What is the study of weather called?

Ans: Meteorology

37. What is the most common element in the universe?

Ans: Hydrogen

38. What organ pumps blood through the body?

Ans: Heart

39. What is the unit used to measure sound intensity?

Ans: Decibel

40. What is Newton's first law of motion also known as?

Ans: Law of inertia

41. What is the chemical symbol for sodium?

Ans: Na

42. What is the main gas responsible for the greenhouse effect?

Ans: Carbon dioxide

43. What part of the plant conducts photosynthesis mainly?

Ans: Leaves

44. What is the term for animals that eat both plants and meat?

Ans: Omnivores

45. What is the resistance unit called?

Ans: Ohm

46. What is the human body's largest internal organ?

Ans: Liver

47. Who is known as the father of modern physics?

Ans: Albert Einstein

48. What is the process of cell division called?

Ans: Mitosis

49. What is the chemical formula for water?

Ans: H₂O

50. What is the term for the study of heredity?

Ans: Genetics

Politics

51. How many members does the UN Security Council have?

Ans: 15

52. What is the term length for a US President?

Ans: 4 years

53. What document begins with 'We the People'?

Ans: The US Constitution

54. Which country has the largest number of UN member votes... trick, all have one vote — what body has veto power?

Ans: UN Security Council permanent members

55. What is a government led by a monarch called?

Ans: Monarchy

56. What is the term for a system of government by the people?

Ans: Democracy

57. How many permanent members are in the UN Security Council?

Ans: 5

58. What is the lower house of the UK Parliament called?

Ans: House of Commons

59. What is the term for a political system with no government?

Ans: Anarchy

60. What is a person who leads a coup called?

Ans: Usually the coup leader or junta head

61. What is the term limit for US Senators?

Ans: 6-year terms, no limit

62. What is the name of India's lower house of Parliament?

Ans: Lok Sabha

63. What is a government run by religious leaders called?

Ans: Theocracy

64. What is the term for rule by a small elite group?

Ans: Oligarchy

65. What year was the United Nations founded?

Ans: 1945

66. What is the official residence of the US President?

Ans: The White House

67. What is the voting age in most democracies including the US?

Ans: 18

68. What is a system with two major political parties called?

Ans: Two-party system

69. What body elects the Pope?

Ans: College of Cardinals

70. What is a legislature with two chambers called?

Ans: Bicameral legislature

71. What is the term for a country ruled by one absolute leader?

Ans: Dictatorship

72. What is the highest court in the United States?

Ans: Supreme Court

73. What is the term for the head of government in the UK?

Ans: Prime Minister

74. What organization is headquartered in Geneva and focuses on global health?

Ans: World Health Organization (WHO)

75. What is the name given to the EU's parliament?

Ans: European Parliament

76. What is the process of removing a president from office before term end called?

Ans: Impeachment

77. What is the term for redrawing electoral boundaries to favor a party?

Ans: Gerrymandering

78. What is the capital city where the UN headquarters is located?

Ans: New York City

79. What is a political system with multiple viable parties called?

Ans: Multi-party system

80. What is the term for a temporary halt to hostilities?

Ans: Ceasefire

81. What treaty founded the European Union?

Ans: Maastricht Treaty

82. What is a vote of 'no confidence' used for?

Ans: To remove a government/leader from power

83. Which international organization sets global trade rules?

Ans: World Trade Organization (WTO)

84. What is the term for citizens directly voting on a law?

Ans: Referendum

85. What branch of US government makes laws?

Ans: Legislative branch (Congress)

86. What is the collective name for laws passed by a legislature?

Ans: Statutes/Acts

87. What is a coalition government?

Ans: A government formed by multiple parties working together

88. What is the term for a leader who takes power by force?

Ans: Dictator/usurper

89. What does NATO stand for?

Ans: North Atlantic Treaty Organization

90. What is the term for diplomatic immunity granted to embassies?

Ans: Extraterritoriality

History

91. In what year did World War II end?

Ans: 1945

92. Who was the first President of the United States?

Ans: George Washington

93. What ancient wonder was located in Giza?

Ans: The Great Pyramid

94. In what year did the Berlin Wall fall?

Ans: 1989

95. Who was the first emperor of Rome?

Ans: Augustus

96. What year did World War I begin?

Ans: 1914

97. Who wrote the Declaration of Independence?

Ans: Thomas Jefferson (principal author)

98. What empire was ruled by Genghis Khan?

Ans: The Mongol Empire

99. In what year did the Titanic sink?

Ans: 1912

100. Who was the British Prime Minister during most of WWII?

Ans: Winston Churchill

101. What was the name of the ship that brought the Pilgrims to America?

Ans: The Mayflower

102. What year did India gain independence from Britain?

Ans: 1947

103. Who painted the Sistine Chapel ceiling?

Ans: Michelangelo

104. What ancient civilization built Machu Picchu?

Ans: The Incas

105. What year did the French Revolution begin?

Ans: 1789

106. Who was the last Pharaoh of Egypt?

Ans: Cleopatra VII

107. What war was fought between the North and South in the US (1861-65)?

Ans: The American Civil War

108. Who was assassinated in Sarajevo in 1914, triggering WWI?

Ans: Archduke Franz Ferdinand

109. What year did man first land on the Moon?

Ans: 1969

110. Who was the leader of Nazi Germany?

Ans: Adolf Hitler

111. What ancient Greek city-state is known for its military discipline?

Ans: Sparta

112. What year did the Roman Empire fall in the West?

Ans: 476 AD

113. Who discovered America in 1492 (per European history)?

Ans: Christopher Columbus

114. What was the name of the period of cultural rebirth in Europe (14th-17th century)?

Ans: The Renaissance

115. Who was the first man in space?

Ans: Yuri Gagarin

116. What treaty ended World War I?

Ans: Treaty of Versailles

117. What wall divided a European capital city during the Cold War?

Ans: The Berlin Wall

118. Who was known as the 'Maid of Orléans'?

Ans: Joan of Arc

119. What dynasty built the Great Wall of China (major construction)?

Ans: The Ming Dynasty

120. What year did the Cold War officially end?

Ans: 1991

121. Who led the Indian independence movement through nonviolence?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi

122. What was the name of the first successful English colony in America?

Ans: Jamestown

123. What year did the French storm the Bastille?

Ans: 1789

124. Who was the Egyptian queen known for her relationship with Julius Caesar and Mark Antony?

Ans: Cleopatra

125. What empire did Alexander the Great build?

Ans: The Macedonian/Greek Empire spanning to India

126. What was the name of the massive 14th-century plague in Europe?

Ans: The Black Death

127. Who was the first female Pharaoh of Egypt?

Ans: Hatshepsut

128. What year did the Soviet Union collapse?

Ans: 1991

129. Who invented the printing press?

Ans: Johannes Gutenberg

130. What was the name of the ancient library destroyed in Egypt?

Ans: The Library of Alexandria

Geography

131. What is the longest river in the world?

Ans: The Nile

132. What is the largest desert in the world?

Ans: The Sahara (or Antarctic Desert if counting cold deserts)

133. What is the smallest country in the world?

Ans: Vatican City

134. What is the tallest mountain in the world?

Ans: Mount Everest

135. What is the largest ocean on Earth?

Ans: The Pacific Ocean

136. What is the capital of Australia?

Ans: Canberra

137. What is the largest country by area?

Ans: Russia

138. What is the longest mountain range in the world?

Ans: The Andes

139. What African country was formerly known as Abyssinia?

Ans: Ethiopia

140. What is the driest place on Earth?

Ans: The Atacama Desert (or Antarctica's dry valleys)

141. What is the capital of Canada?

Ans: Ottawa

142. What is the largest island in the world?

Ans: Greenland

143. What strait separates Europe and Africa?

Ans: The Strait of Gibraltar

144. What is the smallest continent by land area?

Ans: Australia

145. What is the capital of Japan?

Ans: Tokyo

146. What river flows through Egypt?

Ans: The Nile

147. What is the largest lake in the world by surface area?

Ans: The Caspian Sea

148. What mountain range separates Europe and Asia?

Ans: The Ural Mountains

149. What is the capital of Brazil?

Ans: Brasília

150. What is the world's largest coral reef system?

Ans: The Great Barrier Reef

151. What country has the most time zones?

Ans: France (due to overseas territories)

152. What is the deepest point in the ocean?

Ans: The Challenger Deep, Mariana Trench

153. What is the capital of Egypt?

Ans: Cairo

154. What desert covers much of northern China and Mongolia?

Ans: The Gobi Desert

155. What is the largest rainforest in the world?

Ans: The Amazon Rainforest

156. What is the capital of South Korea?

Ans: Seoul

157. What country is both in Europe and Asia?

Ans: Turkey (or Russia/Kazakhstan)

158. What is the tallest waterfall in the world?

Ans: Angel Falls, Venezuela

159. What is the capital of Italy?

Ans: Rome

160. What is the largest freshwater lake by volume?

Ans: Lake Baikal

161. What continent is the Sahara Desert located in?

Ans: Africa

162. What is the capital of Argentina?

Ans: Buenos Aires

163. Which two countries share the longest international border?

Ans: Canada and the United States

164. What sea is the saltiest body of water on Earth?

Ans: The Dead Sea

165. What is the capital of South Africa? (note: 3 capitals)

Ans: Pretoria (administrative), Cape Town (legislative), Bloemfontein (judicial)

166. What is the northernmost capital city in the world?

Ans: Reykjavik, Iceland

167. What is the world's largest archipelago?

Ans: Indonesia

168. What mountain range contains Mount Everest?

Ans: The Himalayas

169. What is the capital of Russia?

Ans: Moscow

170. What is the smallest ocean in the world?

Ans: The Arctic Ocean

Space

171. What is the closest planet to the Sun?

Ans: Mercury

172. What is the largest planet in our solar system?

Ans: Jupiter

173. What galaxy do we live in?

Ans: The Milky Way

174. What is the closest star to Earth (besides the Sun)?

Ans: Proxima Centauri

175. How many moons does Mars have?

Ans: Two (Phobos and Deimos)

176. What is a group of stars forming a recognizable pattern called?

Ans: A constellation

177. What planet is known as the Red Planet?

Ans: Mars

178. What is the name of NASA's most famous reusable spacecraft program?

Ans: The Space Shuttle

179. What force causes objects to have weight?

Ans: Gravity

180. What is the term for a star that explodes?

Ans: Supernova

181. What is the name of the first artificial satellite launched into space?

Ans: Sputnik 1

182. What planet has the most prominent ring system?

Ans: Saturn

183. What is the study of celestial objects called?

Ans: Astronomy

184. What is the name of the collapsed core of a massive star with infinite density?

Ans: Black hole

185. What was the first man-made object to land on the Moon?

Ans: Luna 2 (Soviet)

186. What is the term for the point in orbit closest to the Sun?

Ans: Perihelion

187. How many planets are in our solar system?

Ans: Eight

188. What spacecraft first carried humans to the Moon in 1969?

Ans: Apollo 11

189. What is the name of the telescope launched in 2021 as Hubble's successor?

Ans: James Webb Space Telescope

190. What is the outermost layer of the Sun called?

Ans: The corona

191. What is the term for a small icy body that orbits the Sun and can develop a tail?

Ans: Comet

192. What planet is known for having the strongest winds in the solar system?

Ans: Neptune

193. Who was the first human to walk on the Moon?

Ans: Neil Armstrong

194. What is the name of the dwarf planet beyond Neptune reclassified in 2006?

Ans: Pluto

195. What is the name of the agency that runs Europe's space program?

Ans: European Space Agency (ESA)

196. What is the term for a region of space with no light due to extreme gravity?

Ans: Black hole

197. What is the largest moon in our solar system?

Ans: Ganymede

198. What is the name of SpaceX's crew capsule?

Ans: Crew Dragon

199. How long does it take Earth to orbit the Sun?

Ans: About 365.25 days

200. What is the name of the space station currently orbiting Earth (international collaboration)?

Ans: International Space Station (ISS)

201. What is the term for the explosion believed to have started the universe?

Ans: The Big Bang

202. What planet is closest in size to Earth?

Ans: Venus

203. What is the name of the first woman in space?

Ans: Valentina Tereshkova

204. What causes a solar eclipse?

Ans: The Moon passing between the Earth and Sun

205. What is the hottest planet in the solar system?

Ans: Venus

206. What galaxy is on a collision course with the Milky Way?

Ans: Andromeda Galaxy

207. What is the term for a star's death that leaves behind a dense neutron core?

Ans: Neutron star

208. What mission first landed rovers on Mars for NASA (1997)?

Ans: Mars Pathfinder (Sojourner rover)

209. What is the name of the reusable rocket company founded by Elon Musk?

Ans: SpaceX

210. What is the layer of gases surrounding a planet called?

Ans: Atmosphere

Magic & Mythology

211. Who is considered the father of modern stage magic?

Ans: Jean Eugène Robert-Houdin

212. What famous escape artist was known for handcuff and water tank escapes?

Ans: Harry Houdini

213. In Greek mythology, who is the king of the gods?

Ans: Zeus

214. What is the term for a magic trick where an object seems to disappear?

Ans: Vanish

215. Who is the Norse god of thunder?

Ans: Thor

216. What magician is famous for making the Statue of Liberty 'disappear' on TV?

Ans: David Copperfield

217. In Egyptian mythology, who is the god of the afterlife?

Ans: Osiris

218. What is a magician's assistant traditionally called?

Ans: Assistant/lovely assistant

219. Who is the Greek goddess of wisdom?

Ans: Athena

220. What card trick term refers to secretly controlling a card's position in the deck?

Ans: A 'force' or 'control'

221. In Hindu mythology, who is the god of destruction?

Ans: Shiva

222. What famous magic duo performed with white tigers in Las Vegas?

Ans: Siegfried and Roy

223. Who is the trickster god in Norse mythology?

Ans: Loki

224. What is the study of magic tricks and their history called?

Ans: Prestidigitation / conjuring history

225. In Greek mythology, who flew too close to the Sun with wax wings?

Ans: Icarus

226. What is a false shuffle in card magic used for?

Ans: To appear to shuffle while keeping card order unchanged

227. Who is the Egyptian sun god?

Ans: Ra

228. What legendary wizard advises King Arthur?

Ans: Merlin

229. What is the technical term for sleight of hand?

Ans: Legerdemain

230. In Greek mythology, who is the god of the sea?

Ans: Poseidon

231. What mentalist/magician is known for the show 'Brain Games' and street magic?

Ans: Various — e.g., Criss Angel

232. In Roman mythology, who is the king of the gods (equivalent to Zeus)?

Ans: Jupiter

233. What is a 'palm' in magic terminology?

Ans: Concealing an object in the hand

234. Who is the Greek god of the underworld?

Ans: Hades

235. What famous magician popularized 'street magic' on television in the 2000s?

Ans: David Blaine

236. In Norse mythology, what is the name of the world tree?

Ans: Yggdrasil

237. What is a 'gimmick' in magic?

Ans: A secret device used to create an effect

238. Who is the Greek goddess of love?

Ans: Aphrodite

239. What is the name of the famous magic society based in Hollywood?

Ans: The Magic Castle

240. In Egyptian mythology, who is the goddess of magic herself?

Ans: Isis

241. What is misdirection in magic?

Ans: Diverting the audience's attention from the secret method

242. Who is the Greek god of war?

Ans: Ares

243. What legendary creature is said to grant wishes when its lamp is rubbed?

Ans: A genie/djinn

244. In Hindu mythology, who is the elephant-headed god of wisdom?

Ans: Ganesha

245. What is a 'cold reading' associated with in mentalism?

Ans: Making general statements seem specific/personal without prior information

246. Who is the Roman god of war?

Ans: Mars

247. What is the classic magic phrase often said before a reveal?

Ans: "Abracadabra"

248. In Greek mythology, who is the messenger god?

Ans: Hermes

249. What famous illusionist is known for the 'Transporter' TV special and levitation acts?

Ans: David Copperfield

250. In Celtic mythology, what is a shapeshifting fairy or spirit called?

Ans: A pooka (or similar depending on region)

AI

251. What does 'AI' stand for?

Ans: Artificial Intelligence

252. What does 'LLM' stand for?

Ans: Large Language Model

253. What company developed ChatGPT?

Ans: OpenAI

254. What does 'ML' stand for in the context of AI?

Ans: Machine Learning

255. What is the term for AI systems that learn from labeled data?

Ans: Supervised learning

256. What architecture underlies most modern large language models?

Ans: The Transformer architecture

257. What company created Claude?

Ans: Anthropic

258. What does 'NLP' stand for?

Ans: Natural Language Processing

259. What is the process of adjusting a pretrained model on a specific dataset called?

Ans: Fine-tuning

260. What is a 'neural network' loosely modeled after?

Ans: The human brain's neurons

261. What year was the term 'Artificial Intelligence' coined?

Ans: 1956 (Dartmouth Conference)

262. What technique lets AI generate images from text prompts?

Ans: Diffusion models / text-to-image generation

263. What company developed the AlphaGo program?

Ans: DeepMind

264. What does 'GPT' stand for?

Ans: Generative Pre-trained Transformer

265. What is 'reinforcement learning' based on?

Ans: Learning via rewards and penalties from actions

266. What is a 'chatbot'?

Ans: A program that simulates conversation with users

267. What is 'overfitting' in machine learning?

Ans: When a model learns training data too well and fails to generalize

268. What is the term for data used to train a machine learning model?

Ans: Training data

269. What is 'computer vision'?

Ans: The field of AI focused on interpreting visual data

270. What algorithm mimics natural selection to solve problems?

Ans: Genetic algorithm

271. What is a 'token' in the context of language models?

Ans: A unit of text (word or subword) processed by the model

272. What test proposed by Alan Turing evaluates machine intelligence?

Ans: The Turing Test

273. What is 'RAG' in AI applications?

Ans: Retrieval-Augmented Generation

274. What does 'CNN' stand for in deep learning?

Ans: Convolutional Neural Network

275. What is a 'vector database' used for in AI systems?

Ans: Storing and searching embeddings for similarity retrieval

276. What is 'deep learning' a subset of?

Ans: Machine learning

277. What is 'hallucination' in the context of LLMs?

Ans: When a model generates confident but false or fabricated information

278. What is an 'embedding' in machine learning?

Ans: A numerical vector representation of data like text or images

279. What company created the AI image generator DALL-E?

Ans: OpenAI

280. What is 'prompt engineering'?

Ans: The practice of crafting inputs to get better outputs from AI models

Tech

281. Who co-founded Apple along with Steve Jobs?

Ans: Steve Wozniak

282. What does 'CPU' stand for?

Ans: Central Processing Unit

283. What company created the Android operating system?

Ans: Google

284. What does 'HTML' stand for?

Ans: HyperText Markup Language

285. Who founded Microsoft?

Ans: Bill Gates and Paul Allen

286. What does 'URL' stand for?

Ans: Uniform Resource Locator

287. What does 'RAM' stand for?

Ans: Random Access Memory

288. Who founded Amazon?

Ans: Jeff Bezos

289. What does 'USB' stand for?

Ans: Universal Serial Bus

290. What company owns Instagram?

Ans: Meta (Facebook)

291. What programming language is known for its use in data science and starts with 'P'?

Ans: Python

292. What does 'WWW' stand for?

Ans: World Wide Web

293. Who is credited with inventing the World Wide Web?

Ans: Tim Berners-Lee

294. What does 'GPU' stand for?

Ans: Graphics Processing Unit

295. What company developed the iPhone?

Ans: Apple

296. What does 'SSD' stand for?

Ans: Solid State Drive

297. What social media platform was founded by Mark Zuckerberg?

Ans: Facebook

298. What does 'IP' stand for in networking?

Ans: Internet Protocol

299. What company created the Windows operating system?

Ans: Microsoft

300. What does 'API' stand for?

Ans: Application Programming Interface

301. What does 'Wi-Fi' commonly refer to?

Ans: Wireless networking technology (not technically an acronym, but often linked to wireless fidelity)

302. Who founded Tesla and SpaceX?

Ans: Elon Musk (Tesla co-founder, SpaceX founder)

303. What does 'SQL' stand for?

Ans: Structured Query Language

304. What company created the search engine Google?

Ans: Google (founded by Larry Page and Sergey Brin)

305. What does 'PDF' stand for?

Ans: Portable Document Format

306. What is the name of Microsoft's cloud computing platform?

Ans: Azure

307. What does 'IoT' stand for?

Ans: Internet of Things

308. What company created the Linux kernel?

Ans: Created by Linus Torvalds (open-source, not a company)

309. What does 'VPN' stand for?

Ans: Virtual Private Network

310. What is the name of Amazon's cloud computing platform?

Ans: Amazon Web Services (AWS)